The Back-Office Checklist

27 checks that protect a dental practice's revenue and keep it out of trouble. Tick what's true today.

SMILE MANAGEMENT AND CONSULTING SOLUTIONS

Claims

- ☐ 1 Every claim older than 30 days is worked weekly, with a status note on each one.
- ☐ 2 Denial reasons are tracked, and the most common ones get fixed at the source.
- ☐ 3 Eligibility and benefits are verified at least two business days before each appointment.

Credentialing

- ☐ 4 One list shows every provider, every plan, their status, and each re-credentialing date.
- ☐ 5 Re-credentialing and CAQH re-attestations are started well before any deadline.
- ☐ 6 A new provider's credentialing applications go in months before their first patient, so nobody sees patients under a plan they aren't credentialed with.

Payroll

- ☐ 7 Payroll runs on the same schedule every period, and a second person checks it before it's submitted.
- ☐ 8 Hourly employees' timesheets, including breaks and overtime, are approved by a set cutoff every period.
- ☐ 9 Payroll tax filings and payments are confirmed every quarter, even when a payroll company handles them.

Human Resources

- ☐ 10 Every team member has signed an acknowledgment that they received the current handbook.
- ☐ 11 Personnel files are up to date, with I-9 forms and any employee medical records kept in separate, confidential folders.
- ☐ 12 Every new hire goes through the same written onboarding checklist.

Daily Operations

- ☐ 13 A short morning huddle covers the schedule, open slots, and unscheduled treatment.
- ☐ 14 Appointments are confirmed two to three days ahead, so open slots can still be filled.
- ☐ 15 The front desk handles cancellations and reschedules the same way every time.

Team Management

- ☐ 16 Every person knows their role and the one to three numbers they own.
- ☐ 17 Team meetings happen on a regular schedule, with an agenda and written action items.
- ☐ 18 Every team member gets a one-on-one check-in at least once a quarter.

Production

- ☐ 19 Production and collections are tracked per provider, per day.
- ☐ 20 The unscheduled treatment list is worked every week.
- ☐ 21 The hygiene recall list is worked every week.

Growth

- ☐ 22 Every patient gets the same review request, not just the ones who seem happy.
- ☐ 23 You know where every new patient came from.
- ☐ 24 Patients can request or book an appointment online at any hour.

Money and Compliance

- ☐ 25 Each day's collections in the practice software match the bank deposit and the card batch settlements.
- ☐ 26 Patient credit balances and unapplied insurance payments are reviewed and resolved every month.
- ☐ 27 Every vendor that handles patient information has a signed Business Associate Agreement, and data backups are tested.

My score: ____ / 27 **Missed even three? That's common, and it's fixable.**

Take the free Practice Health Check, or book a free 30-minute call with Janeth: smilemanagementconsultingsnj.com

General operational guidance, not legal, tax or accounting advice.